

MorningOats — FY27 Annual Brand Plan

A flat hot-cereal brand with a fast-growing pocket: play where single-serve and on-the-go win

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Owner Brand Manager — MorningOats
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Brand net revenue (FY25)	~\$93M — Acme's hot-cereal brand
Hot Cereal total	\$2.41B, -0.4% — flat/declining
The growth pocket	Single-Serve Cups +9.8% YoY
FY26 run-rate vs plan	-1.1% (on plan)
FY27 posture	Grow single-serve / on-the-go; hold instant base

Executive summary

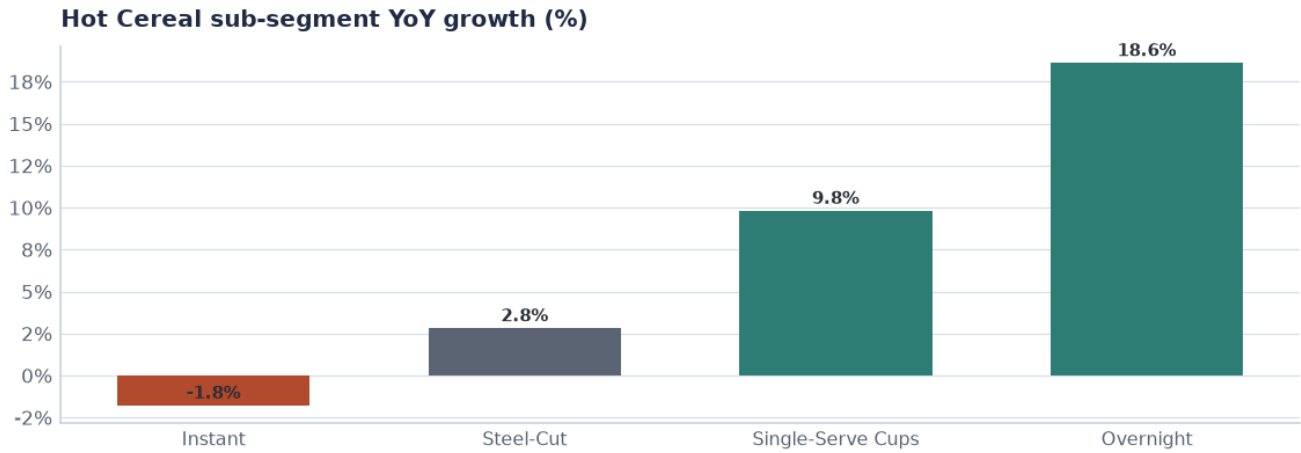
MorningOats is a ~\$93M hot-cereal brand in a category that is going nowhere in aggregate — Hot Cereal total grew -0.4% and Instant, the largest sub-segment, is in decline (-1.8%). But underneath that flat headline is a real growth pocket: Single-Serve Cups grew +9.8% in FY25, where Acme already holds 7% share, and Overnight is the fastest emerging format (+18.6% off a small base). The consumer trend behind it — on-the-go single-serve breakfast (macro strength 0.72, Up) — is durable. MorningOats is on plan today (-1.1% in Q1 FY26). The FY27 plan is a deliberate mix shift: hold the instant base efficiently, and put innovation and A&P behind cups and on-the-go formats where the category is actually growing.

- **Category is flat, but the pocket is hot:** Hot Cereal total -0.4%, Instant -1.8%; Single-Serve Cups +9.8% and Overnight +18.6%. Play where it grows.
- **On plan:** Q1 FY26 net revenue \$23.1M vs \$23.3M plan (-1.1%). Execution is sound; the opportunity is mix, not fixing a miss.
- **Grow single-serve:** Pumpkin Spice Cup LTO (Stage-4, \$1.8M, Q3 FY26) is a near-term, high-confidence (0.72) seasonal win in the growth format.
- **Extend on-the-go:** Overnight Banana prototype (Stage-3, \$2.1M, 2027-Q1 planning estimate) extends the emerging overnight format if MO008 Vanilla validates the occasion.

1 · The category picture — flat total, a growing pocket

BRAND NET REVENUE	HOT CEREAL TOTAL	SINGLE-SERVE CUPS	FY26 VS PLAN	ON-THE-GO MACRO
~\$93M FY25, 8 SKUs	\$2.41B -0.4%	+10% 7% Acme share	-1.1% on plan	0.72 Up

The single most important slide in this plan is the sub-segment growth split. Reading Hot Cereal as one flat number hides the opportunity. Instant — the biggest slice — is declining and dominated by Quaker; steel-cut is a premium niche. But Single-Serve Cups and Overnight are growing double-digit, and they map directly to the on-the-go breakfast occasion where MorningOats' Cup line already over-indexes. FY27 is about deliberately shifting weight into that pocket.



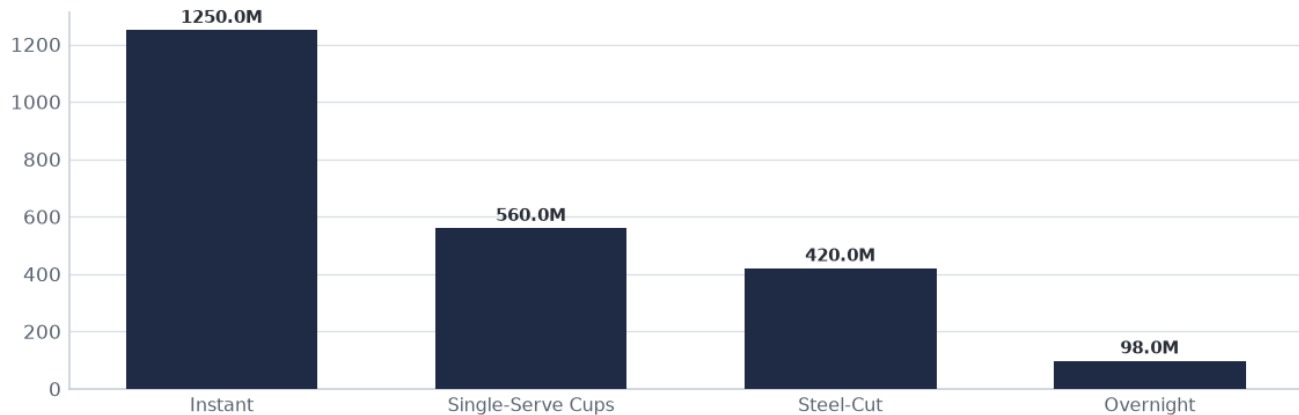
Instant declines; cups (+9.8% FY25) and overnight (+18.6%) grow. The growth is in single-serve / on-the-go, where MorningOats already plays.

Source: category_market_size.csv (NielsenIQ-shape), Hot Cereal sub-segments; Instant/Steel-Cut/Overnight FY24, Single-Serve Cups FY25.

2 · The single-serve opportunity, sized

Single-Serve Cups is a \$0.56B sub-segment growing +9.8%, and Acme holds ~7% of it — well above the ~4% share MorningOats holds in Hot Cereal overall. Three of the brand's eight SKUs are already cups (Maple, Apple Cinnamon, Cinnamon Roll), carrying strong unit velocity at a premium \$2.49 price. This is the brand's right to win: a growing format, a demonstrated share advantage, and a proven consumer occasion. The Overnight sub-segment is smaller and earlier but grows fastest of all; MO008 Overnight Vanilla is the brand's toe-hold there.

Hot Cereal sub-segment size, \$M (where the growth pocket sits)



Cups are a ~\$560M pocket growing +9.8%; overnight is small but +18.6%. Instant is large but declining. MorningOats over-indexes in the growth formats.

The strategic read: mix, not miracles

MorningOats does not need to reverse a category decline; it needs to shift its own mix toward the growing pocket. Every incremental A&P; and innovation dollar should favour cups and on-the-go over defending instant, which is a share-hold job at best.

3 · FY27 innovation plan — grow the growth pocket

3.1 · Pumpkin Spice Cup LTO — the near-term win

The Pumpkin Spice Cup LTO (Stage-4 Pre-Launch, \$1.8M year-one planning estimate, confidence 0.72, Q3 FY26) is the highest-confidence near-term move: a seasonal LTO in the growing cup format, repeating the proven success of the Cinnamon Roll cup. Low risk, on-trend, in the right pocket.

3.2 · Overnight Banana — extend the emerging format

Overnight Banana (Stage-3 Prototype, \$2.1M year-one planning estimate, confidence 0.54, planned 2027-Q1) extends MorningOats into the fastest-growing hot-cereal format. It is explicitly contingent: it advances only if MO008 Overnight Vanilla validates the refrigerator-ready overnight occasion. FY27 funds the prototype and the read on Vanilla, not an unconditional launch. FY27+ revenue is a planning estimate.

Innovation slate — FY27

Concept	Stage	Yr-1 (plan)	Conf.	Launch
MorningOats Cup Pumpkin Spice LTO	Stage-4 Pre-Launch	\$1.8M	0.72	Q3 FY26
MorningOats Overnight Banana	Stage-3 Prototype	\$2.1M	0.54	2027-Q1 (plan)

Source: innovation_pipeline.csv (INV016, INV008). Year-1 revenue & FY27 launch = planning estimates.

4 · The FY27 plan — targets & phasing

FY27 targets modest net-revenue growth driven entirely by mix — cups and on-the-go up, instant held flat — with share gains concentrated in the Single-Serve Cups pocket. The instant base is a defend-and-harvest job. All FY27 figures are targets / planning estimates.

Metric	FY26 (est. actual)	FY27 (target)	Note
Net revenue	~\$92M	~\$93–95M	Modest growth via mix shift
Single-Serve Cups share	~7%	Grow	The right-to-win pocket
Instant base	Declining category	Hold	Defend / harvest efficiently
Innovation live	—	2 (Pumpkin LTO, Overnight Banana)	Both in the growth pocket

Source: plan_vs_actual (FY26 run-rate); category_market_size.csv; innovation_pipeline.csv. FY27 = targets/plan.

Plan phasing — FY27

Quarter	Focus
Q3 FY26	Pumpkin Spice Cup LTO in market; read seasonal cup lift
Q4 FY26 → FY27 Q1	Confirm MO008 Overnight Vanilla occasion; go/no-go on Overnight Banana
FY27 H1	Overnight Banana launch (if validated); grow cup distribution & velocity
FY27 H2	Hold instant base; shift A&P; weight toward on-the-go formats

Watch-item — don't over-fund a niche too early

Overnight is the fastest-growing format but a small absolute pool; Overnight Banana is gated on the MO008 Vanilla read for good reason. The near-term, dependable value is the cup LTO in a proven \$560M+ pocket. Sequence spend accordingly.

Recommendations & next steps

#	Action	Owner	When
1	Launch the Pumpkin Spice Cup LTO in Q3 FY26; treat cups as the priority growth format.	Brand Manager — MorningOats	Q3 FY26
2	Confirm the MO008 Overnight Vanilla occasion read; gate Overnight Banana on the result.	Lillian Park	Q4 FY26
3	Shift FY27 A&P; and shelf weight from instant toward single-serve / on-the-go.	Brand Manager	FY27 planning
4	Grow Single-Serve Cups share; hold the instant base efficiently as a harvest segment.	Brand Manager / Finance	FY27